is characteristic of our generation and environment. Most **of** us accept also certain metaphysical conceptions as part **of the** faith in which we have grown up. I have not been attracted towards metaphysics; in fact, I have had a certain distaste **for** vague speculation. And yet I have sometimes found a certain intellectual fascination in trying to follow the rigid lines **of** metaphysical and philosophic thought of the ancients **or the** moderns. But I have never felt at case there and have escaped from their spell with a feeling of relief.

Essentially, I am interested in this world, in this life, not in some other world or a future life. Whether there is such a thing as a soul, or whether there is a survival after death or not, I **do** not know; and, important as these questions are, they do not trouble me in the least. T h e environment in which I have grown up takes the soul (or rather the *alma)* and a future life, the *Karma* theory of cause and effect, and reincarnation for granted. I have been affected by this and so, in a sense, I am favourably disposed towards these assumptions. There might be a soul which survives the physical death of the body, and a theory of cause and effect governing life's actions seems reasonable,